



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

ākṣiptamoghabījābhyām patyāv apratikarmaṇi | 12.016a
patir anyah smṛto nāryā vatsaraṃ sampratīkṣya tu || 16 || 12.016c

— Nāradaśmṛti, Chapter 12, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This verse from the Narada Smṛiti, Chapter 12, verse 16, delves into the complex landscape of marriage and separation, offering guidance when the marital bond faces severe challenges. It speaks of a situation where the husband is either impotent (“ākṣipta”) or has sown infertile seed (“moghabīja”), and offers no remedy to his condition (“apratikarmaṇi”). In such circumstances, the scripture suggests that a woman, after waiting for a year (“vatsaraṃ sampratīkṣya”), is permitted to seek another husband (“patir anyah smṛto nāryā”).

The context is crucial. This isn't simply about a couple facing difficulties. It addresses a fundamental inability to fulfill the procreative purpose of marriage, coupled with the husband's inaction to address the issue. The waiting period of a year acknowledges the importance of patience and allowing time for potential resolution, preventing hasty decisions based on momentary frustration.

The deeper spiritual interpretation here lies in understanding the sacredness of life and the responsibilities within a marriage. While marriage is a union of souls, it also traditionally held the expectation of continuing the family lineage. The verse acknowledges that when this fundamental purpose is irrevocably thwarted through the husband's condition and inaction, the woman is not bound to a fruitless union. She is granted the possibility of seeking fulfillment and purpose elsewhere, highlighting compassion within the framework of societal norms.

In modern life, this verse resonates with the need for open communication and proactive problem-solving within relationships. While the specific context of procreation may be less emphasized, the underlying principle of addressing fundamental incompatibilities remains relevant. If you find yourself in a relationship where essential needs are consistently unmet and attempts at resolution prove futile, this verse encourages you to assess the situation with patience and discernment. It is a call to honor your own well-being and seek paths toward fulfillment, even if they deviate from conventional expectations. It encourages you to actively address imbalances, rather than remaining passively in situations that hinder your growth and happiness.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you honoring your own well-being within your relationships, and are you willing to address imbalances with courage and compassion?